

Notice of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (September 17, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We deliver information about new regional and analysis reports that JETRO independently produces on the political and economic trends of major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find them useful.

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[Special Feature] Toward the Advent of the Quantum Technology Era <Additional Article>
Deepening Global Innovation

2025 marked the 100th anniversary of quantum mechanics. UNESCO designated this year as the "International Year of Quantum Science and Technology," and initiatives were launched worldwide to promote understanding of quantum science. In recent years, research and development of quantum technology and efforts toward industrialization have made significant progress. Major countries view quantum technology as critical for economic growth and national security, and technological competition and domestic and international collaboration among diverse companies and research institutions are expanding. This special feature focuses on strategies and innovative initiatives toward social implementation of quantum technology in Japan and around the world.

<Additional Article>

◇Developing Use Cases for Quantum Computers: Japan's Industrial Diversity and Technology Foundation as Key

[Central and South America - Mexico] Food Additive Regulations Overhauled for First Time in 14 Years

Integration of approved lists combined with review of usage standards, applications, labeling, and renewal procedures

On August 21, 2026, Mexico's Ministry of Health published a new regulation in the Federal Official Gazette defining additives and processing aids usable in food, beverages, and supplements, as well as their sanitary requirements. The new regulation will take effect in mid-November, 60 business days after publication, and will repeal the 2012 regulation and amendments from 2013 and 2016. This revision encompasses not only integration of approved lists but also usage conditions, pre-evaluation assessments, labeling, transition measures, and future update procedures. The amendments are wide-ranging, and regulatory content may be updated further. This report identifies key points with significant impact on Japanese companies and matters requiring attention going forward.

[North America - Canada]

Clean Technology Industry Cluster in British Columbia: Rise of Regional Issue-Response Companies

British Columbia (BC) on Canada's west coast is widely recognized as a hub for environmental and clean technology (ECT) industries within Canada. The ecosystem, which traditionally developed around hydrogen and fuel cells, continues to expand into broader areas. This article introduces the development history of the industry and trends and future prospects of BC's ECT sector as observed at "Web Summit Vancouver (WSV) 2026," Canada's largest tech conference held in May.

[United States] Current State of U.S. Packaging Material Regulations (5)

Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) Law Implementation Accelerates

Previous articles have explained U.S. packaging material regulations regarding labeling requirements, safety, and components over four installments. In this final article, we introduce the status of seven states that have already implemented Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) laws, which require producers to bear packaging collection and recycling costs, and their impact on companies. The number of U.S. states implementing packaging material EPR laws is expanding, and in leading states, producer registration and fee collection have already begun. Affected companies must promptly confirm whether they qualify as "producers," and must proceed with establishing data management systems for packaging materials and reviewing packaging design.

<Reprint>

Current State of U.S. Packaging Material Regulations

- (1) Labeling Regulations Export Companies Should Note
- (2) Latest Trends in Safety Regulations on Shape and Materials
- (3) PFAS Regulations Advancing at the State Level
- (4) Current State of Plastic Regulations and Preemption Laws

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